more than $1 million worth of brownies a year and had thirty-five employees.

Other Americans I met or corresponded with pursued other unique dreams: A father-and-son team turned family recipes into a $10-million-a-year business making frozen Mexican dinners. In a small town in Illinois, dozens of people lost their jobs when a local factory closed—then, through their own determination and labor, and with a little capital from someone who placed faith in them, they created a thriving metal fabrication business. . . . And they were just a few of the quiet heroes who helped turn around our economy.

As I have often said, governments don't produce economic growth, people do. What government *can* do is encourage Americans to tap their well of ingenuity and unleash their entrepreneurial spirit, then get out of the way.

The tax cuts and the Tax Reform Act allowed people to accumulate money to start new businesses. As the tax laws began to have an effect, people began doing so in record numbers, not only enriching their own lives but adding to the national wealth and helping to send a wave of prosperity across the land.

Reduced interference by the government also helped. Although I wasn't able to eliminate as much governmental red tape as I would have liked, we did manage to reduce government interference in the economy and make available more money for investments in the future.

Then, as I say, Americans did the rest.